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What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Annual inflation** heated up slightly in September, but not as much as economists expected, giving the Fed a clear path for widely expected rate cuts in the remainder of 2025. **A1**
- ◆ **Social Security benefits** for retirees will rise 2.8% in 2026, reflecting the recent pickup in inflation. **A2**
- ◆ **The Dow surpassed 47000** for the first time, closing up 2.2% for the week, while the S&P 500 and Nasdaq logged their second straight weekly gains, rising 0.8% and 1.2%, respectively, on Friday. **B11**
- ◆ **Procter & Gamble** reported higher first-quarter sales and said it would draw cautious consumers with product innovation instead of lower prices. **B10**
- ◆ **Zelle, the payments** product owned by some of the largest U.S. banks, said it would allow users to start making international payments via stablecoins. **B11**
- ◆ **Porsche reported its** first quarterly loss in years after taking a charge tied to a premature bet on EVs. **B10**

ASKING THE
RIGHT QUESTION
CAN GREATLY
IMPACT YOUR FUTURE...
ESPECIALLY WHEN
IT COMES TO YOUR
FINANCES.

World-Wide

- ◆ **Canadian Prime Minister** Mark Carney said he was ready to resume trade talks “when the Americans are ready,” a day after Trump said he was terminating them because of an anti-tariff ad campaign sponsored by Ontario’s government. **A1, A10**
- ◆ **New York Attorney General** Letitia James pleaded not guilty to a pair of felony charges, and a judge said the trial would begin Jan. 26. **A3**
- ◆ **Trump’s announcement** that he wouldn’t send federal troops to San Francisco followed an exchange of calls and texts between the president, members of his administration, tech leaders and the city’s mayor. **A3**
- ◆ **Senior White House** and Navy officials are in talks to replace the current mix of warships with a fleet better suited to counter China and other potential future threats. **A6**
- ◆ **The Pentagon plans** to send an aircraft carrier to the Caribbean, escalating the administration’s campaign against drug smugglers and Latin American governments. **A6**

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A republic, but can we keep it? **A15**

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Putting the World in World Series



INTERNATIONAL PASTIME: Blue Jay Vladimir Guerrero Jr. warms up Friday before Game 1 in Toronto against the Los Angeles Dodgers. A Canadian village claims to be baseball’s birthplace. **A12**

Inflation Accelerates to 3%,
But Is Less Than Expected

By KONRAD PUTZIER
AND HARRIET TORRY

Annual inflation heated up slightly in September, but not as much as economists expected, giving the Federal Reserve a clear path for widely expected rate cuts heading into their remaining meetings this year.

Consumer prices rose 3%

from a year earlier, the Labor Department said Friday, slightly hotter than August’s increase of 2.9% and the fastest pace since January. A measure of core prices that strips out volatile food and energy costs also increased 3%. Both came in below economists’ expectations for a 3.1% rise as pressure on housing costs eased.

Inflation remains a sticky

issue, with price increases above where policymakers want them. The latest report indicates retailers continue to pass some tariff-related costs on to consumers, contributing

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- ◆ **COLA to boost Social Security pay by 2.8%..... A2**
- ◆ **Consumer sentiment declines for month..... A3**

NBA Bets Big on Gambling, Wins Itself a Crisis

By ROBERT O’CONNELL
AND LOUISE RADNOFSKY

When federal agents announced charges against more than 30 people involved in a sprawling gambling probe on Thursday morning, the specifics of the case were gripping. There were underground poker games, X-ray tables, tips whispered to bettors about where to put their money in

professional basketball games. But for the NBA, the general picture that emerged—at a Brooklyn news conference across the East River from the league’s Fifth Avenue offices—was much more chilling. Prosecutors unveiled an indictment that featured an active player, a retired one and a current head coach spilling secrets to illegal gamblers. It was a “fraud,” FBI Direc-

tor Kash Patel said, “that these perpetrators committed on the grand stage of the NBA.” It is also an existential threat to professional sports, and perhaps the defining crisis of Adam Silver’s tenure as NBA commissioner. Silver was an early proponent of legalized sports gambling in the U.S. and had long argued that legal betting would have the positive effect of bringing

U.S.-Canada
Fight Upends
Trade Talks

Prime Minister Mark Carney of Canada said he was ready to resume trade negotiations “when the Americans are ready,” one day after Pres-

By Vipal Monga Gavin
Bade, and Alex Leary

ident Trump said he was terminating the talks because of an anti-tariff advertisement campaign sponsored by the Ontario government.

Doug Ford, the premier of the province, said on Friday that after talking with Carney he would pause its U.S. ad campaign effective Monday.

But the White House waved away Carney’s conciliatory comments, with spokesperson Kush Desai saying “further talks are a futile effort if Canada can’t be serious.”

The dispute injects new uncertainty into U.S.-Canada relations at a critical time for both economies. In addition to recent talks on steel and aluminum tariffs, the nations are also preparing for a review of the U.S.-Mexico-Canada Agreement scheduled for next

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- ◆ **Ontario premier derails negotiations..... A10**

Xi Thinks He Has
Trump’s Number

By LINGLING WEI

During his first term, President Trump often frustrated Xi Jinping with his freewheeling mix of threats and bonhomie. This time, the Chinese leader believes he has cracked the code.

Xi has thrown out China’s traditional diplomatic playbook and tailored a new one specifically for Trump, said people close to Chinese policymakers, who describe Xi as appearing confident and em-

boldened. The new strategy, these people said, embraces Trump’s self-image as a master dealmaker, offering concessions on high-visibility issues he personally cares about, such as the fate of popular video-sharing app TikTok.

But when the Trump administration hits China, Xi has decided to hit back even harder, in a bid to gain leverage over Trump while projecting strength and unpredict-

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EXCHANGE



SIX FLAGS

How Travis Kelce wound up on a wild ride to save America’s biggest theme-park operator. **B1**

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Women’s Pay Declines
As Return-to-Office
Requirements Pick Up

By HARRIET TORRY

Women who want work-from-home flexibility are finding it comes with a price.

By last year, women working full time made 81 cents on the dollar compared with men, the widest pay gap since 2016, according to the Census Bureau’s latest data. And more recent numbers from the Labor Department indicate men are outpacing women this year, too, when it comes to weekly earnings growth.

Economists examining the widening gap said there are likely several factors at play, including the high cost and scarce availability of affordable child care. But their leading theory is the effort by many companies to get workers back into offices, which can prompt some women to

quit, turn down promotions or opt for lower-paying jobs with more flexibility.

Women have fallen behind in the return-to-office push, reflecting the barriers they can still hit when juggling careers and families, even after decades of workplace gains.

“This traces back to gender norms in society in general that put a disproportionate share of household responsibilities and child care on women,” said Francine Blau, an economics professor at Cornell University.

By the time Jane Varble’s maternity leave for her second child ended in February, the Covid-19-era option of working remotely a couple of days a week at her St. Louis-based accounting job for the federal government had ended.

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‘KPop’ Craze
Sends Parents
Into a Panic

* * *

Desperate search
for costumes
hijacks Halloween

By ROBBIE WHELAN

Kelly Binning’s 9-year-old daughter Alana badly wanted to dress up for Halloween as the knife-slinging rapper named Zoey from “KPop Demon Hunters,” the global phenomenon and surprise hit movie of the year.

Online, Binning found slim pickings. She ordered a Chinese knockoff on Amazon.com in the 12-year-old fit for \$26.79, but when it arrived it was toddler-sized. Frantic, she scoured retail stores until she found the last-available Zoey costume, just in time for the first party of the season.

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